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Double door gate apparatus

Abstract

The present double door gate apparatus has a first lowermost frame member with a first inner end and a second lowermost frame member with a second inner end. The first and second inner ends are spaced apart and engaged by a first connector that engages exterior portions of the inner ends and a second connector that engages interior portions of the inner ends. First and second gates have inner ends that confront each other more closely than the inner ends of the lowermost frame members confront each other.

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Background/Summary

(1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/346,239 filed Jan. 12, 2021 (U.S. Pat. No. 11,668,134 issued Jun. 6, 2023) and claims the benefit thereof under 35 U.S.C. § 120, which application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/871,042 filed Jan. 14, 2018 (U.S. Pat. No. 11,035,173 issued Jun. 15, 2021) and claims the benefit thereof under 35 U.S.C. § 120, which application claims the benefit under 35 U.S.C. 119 (e) of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/446,782 filed Jan. 16, 2017, which nonprovisional and provisional applications are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties into this application.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates generally to a double door gate apparatus, more particularly to a double door gate apparatus where each gate has a lowermost frame member with an inner end, and specifically to one or more connectors for engaging each of the inner ends.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) A product may be manufactured and packaged in an unassembled form at one location where it is stored until shipment. Then the packaged product may be shipped by one or more means of transportation, such as by air, sea, and/or land. The packaged product may make one or more layovers, such as in a port awaiting inspection, at a distribution center, or in a retail store, until the packaged product reaches its final destination, such as a residence or workplace. Regardless of where the packaged product is at any one point in time, space is usually at a premium.

(3) The product may then be assembled by the end user. In the assembled form, the product more often than not takes up a greater amount of space. In the assembled form, it is likely desired that the product have certain characteristics such as strength, stability and safety.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(4) A feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a first frame, where the first frame includes a first end frame member that extends vertically and a first lowermost frame member that extends horizontally, where the first lowermost frame member includes a first inner end, and where the first inner end includes a top face, front face, and rear face.

(5) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a first gate engaged to the first frame.

(6) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a second frame, where the second frame includes a second end frame member that extends vertically and a second lowermost frame member that extends horizontally, where the second lowermost frame member includes a second inner end, and where the second inner end includes a top face, front face and rear face.

(7) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a second gate engaged to the second frame.

(8) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a first connector engaging the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member to the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member, and where the first connector engages exterior portions of the first and second inner ends.

(9) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a second connector engaging the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member to the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member, where the second connector engages interior portions of the first and second inner ends.

(10) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the first connector including an elongate rigid brace, where the elongate rigid brace is integral and one-piece, where the elongate rigid brace includes a first U-shaped section that engages the top, front and rear faces of the first inner end, where the elongate rigid brace includes a second U-shaped section that engages the top, front and rear faces of the second inner end, and where the first and second frames are nonpivotable relative to each other when the elongate rigid brace is engaged to the first and second inner ends.

(11) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the first inner end being tubular and including a first opening, where the second inner end is tubular and includes a second opening, where the second connector includes an elongate insert having first and second insert ends, where the first insert end is engagable with the first opening, and where the second insert end is engagable with the second opening.

(12) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the elongate insert being rigid such that, when the elongate rigid insert is engaged in the first and second openings, the first and second frames are nonpivotable relative to each other.

(13) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the elongate insert including a pivot mechanism between the first and second insert ends such that, when the elongate insert is engaged in the first and second openings, the first frame is pivotable relative to the second frame.

(14) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the first connector and the second connector being independent of each other and spaced apart from each other.

(15) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the first connector including an upper plate portion, the upper plate portion including a raised oblong section.

(16) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the first connector including an upper plate portion, a front plate portion, and a rear plate portion, where the upper plate portion, front plate portion, and rear plate portion are integral and one-piece and form a U-shape.

(17) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the upper plate portion including a raised oblong section, where the raised oblong section is spaced from the front plate portion and the rear plate portion.

(18) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the raised oblong section including a length having a first distance, where the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member is spaced from the first inner end of the second lowermost frame member by a second distance when the first connector is engaged to the inner ends, and where the first distance is greater than the second distance.

(19) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the first connector having a length with a first distance, where the first gate includes a first gate frame having a first inner end, where the second gate includes a second gate frame having a second inner end, where the first gate frame is spaced apart from the second gate frame by a second distance when the first and second gates are closed, and where the first distance is greater than the second distance.

(20) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member being spaced from the first inner end of the second lowermost frame member by a first distance when the first connector is engaged to the inner ends, where the first gate includes a first gate frame having a first inner end, where the second gate includes a second gate frame having a second inner end, where the first gate frame is spaced apart from the second gate frame by a second distance when the first and second gates are closed, and where the first distance is greater than the second distance.

(21) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a first outer end portion of the first connector being pinned to the first lowermost frame member, and of a second outer end portion of the first connector being pinned to the second lowermost frame member.

(22) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a connector engaging the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member to the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member, where the connector engages exterior portions of the first and second inner ends, of the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member being spaced from the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member by a first distance when the connector is engaged to the inner ends, of the first gate including a first gate frame having a first inner end, where the second gate includes a second gate frame having a second inner end, where the first inner end of the first gate frame is spaced apart from the second inner end of the second gate frame by a second distance when the first and second gates are closed, and of the first distance being greater than the second distance.

(23) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a connector engaging the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member to the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member, where the connector engages interior portions of the first and second inner ends, of the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member being spaced from the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member by a first distance when the

connector is engaged to the inner ends of the lowermost horizontal frame members, of the first gate including a first gate frame having a first inner end, where the second gate includes a second gate frame having a second inner end, where the first inner end of the first gate frame is spaced apart from the second inner end of the second gate frame by a second distance when the first and second gates are closed, and of the first distance being greater than the second distance.

(24) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member being engaged to the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member such as by a direct engagement or indirect engagement, where the first gate includes a first gate frame having inner and outer end frame members and top and bottom frame members, where the outer end frame member defines a pivot axis on which the first gate swings, where the outer end frame member of the first gate frame includes an upper end portion and wherein the top frame member of the first gate frame includes an outer end portion, where a junction engages the upper end portion of the outer end frame member of the first gate frame to the outer end portion of the top frame member of the first gate frame, where the junction receives the upper end portion therein and wherein the junction receives the outer end portion therein, and where the junction extends obliquely from the outer end frame member of the first gate frame to the top frame member of the first gate frame to permit the first gate to be lifted axially on the pivot axis.

(25) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of a piece on the first base frame having a first and second stop, where the first stop abuts a first portion of the junction when the first gate is raised, and where the second stop abuts a second portion of the junction when the first gate is at a rest position so as to prevent the first gate from being raised.

(26) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the second stop being pivotable to an out-of-the-way position to permit the first gate to be raised.

(27) Another feature of the present invention is the provision in a double door gate apparatus, of the outer end frame member of the first gate frame having a shorter length than the inner end frame member of the first gate frame, and of the top frame member having a shorter length than the bottom frame member.

(28) An advantage of the present invention is that the size of an unassembled double door gate apparatus can be shipped in a carton of minimal size.

(29) Another advantage of the present invention is that the assembled double door gate apparatus is safe and sturdy.

(30) Another advantage of the present invention is that unassembled double door gate apparatus can be quickly assembled.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of the double door gate apparatus of the present invention being connected in fencing.

(2) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the double door gate apparatus of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3A is a perspective view of first and second connectors between the first and second gate frames of FIG. 2.

(4) FIG. 3B is a perspective view of the first and second connectors of FIG. 3A.

(5) FIG. 3C is a side view of the first and second connectors of FIG. 3A.

(6) FIG. 4A is a top perspective isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 3A.

(7) FIG. 4B is a top isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 4A.

(8) FIG. 4C is bottom perspective isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 4A.

(9) FIG. 4D is a bottom perspective isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 4A.

- (10) FIG. 4E is a side isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 4A.
- (11) FIG. 4F is an end isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 4A.
- (12) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of the lift inhibitor or pivoting stop of the double door gate apparatus of FIG. 2.
- (13) FIG. 6A is a top perspective isolated view of the lift inhibitor of FIG. 5.
- (14) FIG. 6B is a top isolated view of the lift inhibitor of FIG. 6A.
- (15) FIG. 6C is a bottom perspective isolated view of the lift inhibitor of FIG. 6A.
- (16) FIG. 6D is a bottom isolated view of the lift inhibitor of FIG. 6A.
- (17) FIG. 6E is a section view of the lift inhibitor of FIG. 6A.
- (18) FIG. 6F is an end isolated view of the lift inhibitor of FIG. 6A.
- (19) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of the latch apparatus of the double door gate apparatus of FIG. 2.
- (20) FIG. 8A is a top perspective isolated view of an alternate embodiment of the second connector of FIG. 4A.
- (21) FIG. 8B is a top isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 8A.
- (22) FIG. 8C is bottom perspective isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 8A.
- (23) FIG. 8D is a bottom perspective isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 8A.
- (24) FIG. 8E is a side isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 8A.
- (25) FIG. 8F is an end isolated view of the second connector of FIG. 8A.
- (26) FIG. 9 is a perspective view of the double door gate apparatus with the alternate second connector of FIG. 8A.

DESCRIPTION

- (27) As shown in FIG. 1, the present double door gate apparatus is indicated by the reference numeral **10**. As to the double door gate apparatus **10**, the following U.S. patents are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties: 1) the Flannery et al. U.S. Pat. No. 9,382,740 dated Jul. 5, 2016 and entitled Double Door Gate Apparatus, and 2) the Flannery et al. U.S. Pat. No. 9,382,750 dated Jul. 5, 2016 and entitled Double Door Gate Apparatus.
- (28) The double door gate apparatus **10** is engaged in fencing **12**. As to fencing **12**, the Flannery U.S. Pat. No. 7,887,029 dated Feb. 15, 2011 and entitled In-House Gated Safety Barrier Having Customizable Layout is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.
- (29) The outer ends of the fencing **12** may be mounted to a vertical surface with brackets **14**. Such vertical surface may be other fencing, an outside wall such as a brick or cement block wall, the exterior of a house, or a vertical surface in a house or other structure.
- (30) The outer ends of the double door gate apparatus **10** may be mounted to a vertical surface directly or with brackets such as brackets **14**. Such vertical surface may be other fencing, an outside wall such as a brick or cement block wall, the exterior of a house, or a vertical surface in a house or other structure.
- (31) The double door gate apparatus **10** is shown in greater detail in FIG. 2. Double door gate apparatus **10** includes a first base frame **16**, a first gate **18**, a first gate frame **20**, a second base frame **22**, a second gate **24**, and a second gate frame **26**.
- (32) The first and second gates **18**, **24** are engaged to each other by a top latch apparatus **28**.
- (33) First base frame **16** is generally L-shaped. First base frame **16** includes a vertical support member or standard **30** rigidly fixed, such as by welding, to a lowermost horizontal frame member **32**. Vertical and horizontal frame members **30**, **32** are formed of a metal such as steel or aluminum, are tubular, and are rectangular or square in section from end to end. Vertical and horizontal frame members **30**, **32** define a plane.
- (34) An upper piece **34** is engaged to the upper end of vertical frame member **30**. Upper piece **34** includes a lower and outer portion **36** that extends outwardly to engage fencing **12**. Upper piece **34** includes an upper and inner portion **38** that extends inwardly to serve as a mount for a vertical post **40** that in turn engages first gate **18**.
- (35) Vertical post **40** may extend from upper and inner portion **38**, downwardly through a tubular

outer end frame member **42** of the first gate frame **20**, and to lowermost horizontal frame member **32** to which the vertical post **40** is engaged. Vertical post **40** serves as a pivot upon which first gate **18** swings. If desired, vertical post **40** may be replaced by an upper post portion and a lower post portion, where the upper post portion engages the upper and inner portion **38** and an upper portion of the tubular outer end frame member **42**, where the lower post portion engages the lowermost horizontal frame member **32** and a lower portion of the tubular outer end frame member **42**, and where the upper post portion and lower post portion are separate pieces spaced apart from each other.

(36) Lowermost horizontal frame member **32** includes an outer end **44** and an inner end **46**. The junction between the vertical support member **30** and the lowermost horizontal frame member **32** is set inwardly from and spaced from the outer end **44**. Vertical support member **30** is set on top of lowermost horizontal frame member **32**. Outer end **44** is engaged to fencing **12**. Lowermost horizontal frame member **32** includes a pair of side faces, a top face, and a bottom face. Such side faces oppose each other. Such top and bottom faces oppose each other.

(37) First gate frame **20** includes tubular outer end frame member **42**, inner end frame member **48**, upper frame member **50** and lower frame member **52**. Outer end frame member **42** is shorter in length than inner end frame member **48**. Upper or top frame member **50** is shorter in length than lower or bottom frame member **52**. Outer end frame member **42** and upper or top frame member **50** terminate in the oblique junction **56** and do not further proceed in a straight line to meet each other. First gate frame **20** further includes a set of six vertical frame members **54**. Vertical frame members **42**, **54** and **48** are spaced equidistantly from adjacent vertical frame members **42**, **54**, and **48**.

Vertical frame members **42**, **54** and **48** run parallel to each other. Vertical frame members **54** run to and between the bottom face of upper frame member **50** and the top face of lower frame member **52**. Tubular outer end frame member **42** extends a distance that is shorter than a straight distance from the lower end of upper and inner portion **38** and the top face of the lowermost horizontal frame member **32** such that tubular outer end frame member **42** is slideable vertically on post **40** when the first gate **18** is lifted and lowered. Inner end frame member **48** extends from the bottom face of upper frame member **50** to the inner end of lower frame member **52** where the bottom end of inner end frame member **48** is flush with the bottom face of lower frame member **52**. Lower frame member **52** extends from inner end frame member **48** to a side face of tubular outer end frame member **42**. Upper frame member **50** extends from a top of inner frame member **48**, where an inner end of upper frame member **50** is flush with the inner face of inner end frame member **48**, to a junction **56**. If desired, upper frame member **50** may extend slightly inwardly of inner end frame member **48** to provide for more engagement with top latch apparatus **28**.

(38) First gate frame **20** further includes the junction **56**. Junction **56** extends between the upper frame member **50** and the tubular outer end frame member **42**. Junction **56** depends in a stepped manner from upper frame member **50** to tubular outer end frame member **42** to provide a space for the tubular inner end frame member **42** to be raised and lowered relative to upper piece **34** and lowermost horizontal frame member **32**.

(39) First base frame **16** includes pivoting stop **58**. Pivoting stop **58** prevents the tubular inner frame member **42** and the first gate **18** from being raised when the pivoting stop **58** abuts the top face of junction **56**. Pivoting stop **58** permits the tubular inner frame member **42** and the first gate **18** to be raised when the pivoting stop **58** is moved out of the way. Pivoting stop **58** is pivotably engaged to piece **34**.

(40) First gate **18** includes inverted U-shaped stop **60**. U-shaped stop **60** is rigidly affixed to the lower frame member **52** toward the inner end of the first gate **18**. U-shaped stop **60** is immediately adjacent to the vertical support member **54** which in turn is immediately adjacent to the inner end frame member **48**. U-shaped stop **60** includes two sides. Each of the sides of the U-shaped stop **60** includes inner face portions that are rigidly affixed to the side faces of lower frame member **52** of the first gate frame **20**. Each of the sides of the U-shaped stop **60** includes inner face portions that

confront and abut but do not adhere to side faces of the lowermost horizontal frame member **32** of first base frame **16**. Lowermost horizontal frame member **32** has a greater width than does lower frame member **52** such that each of the sides of U-shaped member **60** has a stepped structure. When first gate **18** is raised, the lower ends of the sides of the U-shaped stop **60** clear the top face of lowermost horizontal frame member **32** such that the first gate **18** may be swung to either side of the double door gate apparatus **10**.

(41) Second base frame **22** is generally L-shaped. Second base frame **22** includes a vertical support member or standard **62** rigidly fixed, such as by welding, to a lowermost horizontal frame member **64**. Vertical and horizontal frame members **62**, **64** are formed of a metal such as steel or aluminum, are tubular, and are rectangular or square in section from end to end. Vertical and horizontal frame members **62**, **64** of second base frame **22** define a plane and lie coplanar with vertical and horizontal frame members **30**, **32** of the first base frame **16**.

(42) An upper piece **66** is engaged to the upper end of vertical frame member **62**. Upper piece **66** includes a lower and outer portion **68** that extends outwardly to engage fencing **12**. Upper piece **66** includes an upper and inner portion **70** that extends inwardly to serve as a mount for a vertical post that in turn engages second gate **24**.

(43) Such a vertical post may extend from upper and inner portion **70**, downwardly through a tubular outer end frame member **72** of the second gate frame **26**, and to lowermost horizontal frame member **64** to which such vertical post is engaged. Such vertical post serves as a pivot upon which second gate **24** swings. If desired, such vertical post may be replaced by an upper post portion and a lower post portion, where the upper post portion engages the upper and inner portion **70** and an upper portion of the tubular outer end frame member **72**, where the lower post portion engages the lowermost horizontal frame member **64** and a lower portion of the tubular outer end frame member **72**, and where the upper post portion and lower post portion are separate pieces spaced apart from each other.

(44) Lowermost horizontal frame member **64** includes an outer end **74** and an inner end **76**. The junction between the vertical support member **62** and the lowermost horizontal frame member **64** is set inwardly from and spaced from the outer end **74**. Vertical support member **62** is set on top of lowermost horizontal frame member **64**. Outer end **74** is engaged to fencing **12**. Lowermost horizontal frame member **64** includes a pair of side faces, a top face, and a bottom face. Such side faces oppose each other. Such top and bottom faces oppose each other.

(45) Second gate frame **26** includes tubular outer end frame member **72**, inner end frame member **78**, upper frame member **80** and lower frame member **82**. Second gate frame **26** further includes a set of six vertical frame members **84**. Vertical frame members **72**, **84** and **78** are spaced equidistantly from adjacent vertical frame members **72**, **84**, and **78**. Vertical frame members **72**, **84** and **78** run parallel to each other. Vertical frame members **84** run to and between the bottom face of upper frame member **80** and the top face of lower frame member **82**. Tubular outer end frame member **72** extends a distance that is substantially the same or slightly less than a straight distance from the lower end of upper and inner portion **70** and the top face of the lowermost horizontal frame member **64** such that tubular outer end frame member **72** is pivotable vertically on the inner post running through member **72** when the second gate **24** is swung open and swung closed.

(46) Inner end frame member **78** extends from the bottom face of upper frame member **80** to the inner end of lower frame member **82** where the bottom end of inner end frame member **78** is flush with the bottom face of lower frame member **82**. Lower frame member **82** extends from inner end frame member **78** to a side face of tubular outer end frame member **72**. Upper frame member **80** extends from a top of inner frame member **78**, where an inner end of upper frame member **80** is flush with the inner face of inner end frame member **78**, to the inner face of tubular outer end vertical support member **72**. If desired, upper frame member **80** may extend slightly inwardly of inner end frame member **78** to provide for more engagement with top latch apparatus **28**.

(47) Second gate **24** includes downwardly extending stop **86**. Stop **86** is rigidly affixed to the lower

frame member **82** toward the inner end of the second gate **24**. Stop **86** is immediately adjacent to the vertical support member **84** which in turn is immediately adjacent to the inner end frame member **78**. Stop **86** includes a single side. While stop **86** is rigidly affixed to lower frame member **82**, stop **86** is not affixed to but abuts lowermost horizontal support member **64**. Stop **86** includes a lower end that is disposed at a lower elevation than the top face of lowermost horizontal support member **64** such that second gate **24** is swingable in only one direction and is not swingable completely over the lowermost horizontal support member **64** to the other side of the double door gate apparatus **10**.

(48) FIG. **2** further shows the first connector **88** and the second connector **90**. The first connector **88** extends to and between exterior portions of the lowermost horizontal frame members **32**, **64**. The second connector **90** extends to and between interior portions of the lowermost horizontal frame members **32**, **64**.

(49) As shown in FIGS. **3A**, **3B** and **3C**, first connector **88** includes an elongate rigid U-shaped brace **92**. Brace **92** is U-shaped from end to end. Brace **92** is integral and one-piece. A first U-shaped section of brace **92** engages the top, front and rear faces of an inner end portion of the lowermost horizontal support member **32** of the first base frame **16**. A second U-shaped section of brace **92** engages the top, front and rear faces of an inner end portion of the lowermost horizontal support member **64** of the second base frame **22**. Outer end portions of the elongate rigid brace are pinned with pin connectors **94** to the inner end portions of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**. The first and second base frames **16**, **22** are nonpivotable relative to each other when the rigid elongate brace **92** is pinned to the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**. Elongate rigid brace **92** captures each of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64** on three side or three faces of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64** to minimize swing of the first and second base frames **16**, **22** relative to each other. A drawing apart of the first and second base frames **16**, **22** away from each other in a straight line is minimized by the pinning of the elongate base **92** to the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64** by the pin connectors **94**. Elongate rigid U-shaped brace **92** further includes a raised oblong section **96** that is formed in the top plate portion **98**, that is spaced from the front plate portion **100**, that is spaced from the rear plate portion **102**, that is spaced from the pin connectors **94**, and that is spaced from each of the ends of the rigid brace **92**. Top plate portion **98**, front plate portion **100**, and rear plate portion **102** form the U-shape of the rigid brace **92**. Rigid brace **92** may be referred to as a stiffener. Raised oblong section **96** provides for greater rigidity for top plate portion **98** and thus provides for greater rigidity for elongate brace **92** as a whole.

(50) The raised oblong section **96** includes a length having a first distance. The first inner end **46** of the first lowermost frame member **32** is spaced from the second inner end **76** of the second lowermost frame member **64** by a second distance. When the first connector **88** is engaged to the inner ends **46**, **76**, the first distance is greater than the second distance. When packaged in an unassembled form, the outer end tubular support member **42** may be on top of or abutting the standard **30** of the first base frame **16** such that the inner end of gate **18** does not extend beyond the inner end **46** of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. However, when assemble, the first gate **18** is engaged at another location, namely at the distal end **135** of piece **34** such that the inner end of gate **18** or the inner end vertical support member **48** of gate **18** extends beyond the inner end **46** of lowermost horizontal support member **32**.

(51) The first connector **88** has a length of a first distance. The first gate **18** includes a first gate frame **20** having a first inner end. The second gate **24** includes a second gate frame **26** with a second inner end. The first gate frame **20** is spaced apart from the second gate frame **26** by a second distance when the first and second gates **18**, **24** are closed. Here the first distance is greater than the second distance.

(52) The first inner end **46** of the first lowermost frame member **32** is spaced from the second inner end **76** of the second lowermost frame member **64** by a first distance when the first connector **88** is

engaged to the inner ends **46**, **76**. The first gate **18** includes a first gate frame **20** having a first inner end. The second gate **24** includes a second gate frame **26** having a second inner end. The first gate frame **20** is spaced apart from the second gate frame **26** by a second distance when the first and second gates **18**, **24** are closed. Here the first distance is greater than the second distance.

(53) Second connector **90** is shown in FIGS. 3A, 3B, 3C and is further shown in FIGS. 4A, 4B, 4C, 4D, 4E and 4F. Second connector **90** includes a first portion **104** and a second portion **106** engaged by a pivot pin **108**. First portion **104** is integral and one-piece. Second portion **106** is integral and one-piece.

(54) First portion **104** includes an insertable male section **110** that that is rectangular in section and that is inserted into the open female end **46** of lowermost horizontal support member **32**. On each of its front and rear faces, insertable male section **110** includes a pair of vertically extending spaced apart nubs **112** or raised sections **112** that offer a friction fit with the associated inside faces of the interior of the female open end **46** of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. Except for the raised sections **112**, insertable male section **110** has a width that is substantially equal to the distance between the inside front and rear faces of open female end **46** and its lowermost horizontal support member **32** and a height that is substantially equal to the distance between the inside bottom and top surfaces of the open female end **46** and its lowermost horizontal support member **32**. The top and bottom faces of insertable male section **110** are smooth and flat and planar and have no raised sections. Insertable male section **110** is hidden from view when in lowermost horizontal support member **32**.

(55) First portion **104** includes a visible stop section **114**. Visible stop section **114** is rectangular in section and includes a width and height greater than the respective width and height of insertable male section **110** of first portion **104**. The width and height of visible stop section **114** is substantially the same as the width and height of the outside faces of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. When the insertable male section **110** of first portion **104** is inserted into the open female end **46**, a rectangular stop edge **116** stops the insertion of the first portion **104** into the lowermost horizontal support member **32** by abutting up against the inner end **46** of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. When first portion **104** is engaged to the open female end **46** of lowermost horizontal frame support member **32**, visible stop section **114** of first portion **104** is visible.

(56) First portion **104** includes a disk like section **118** extending from the outer end of visible stop section **114** of first portion **104**. Disk like section **118** extends from a horizontally extending mid-portion of the inner end face of visible stop section **114** of first portion **104**. Disk like section **118** is spaced from the top and bottom of the visible stop section **114**. Disk like section **118** includes a circular circumference that extends for about 270 degrees of a total circumference of the disk like section **118**. About one-half of the disk like section **118** extends beyond the front face of the double door gate apparatus **10** where the front face of the double door gate apparatus **10** is defined by the front faces of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**, which front faces are co-planar. The remaining one-half of the disk like section **118** is disposed between the front and rear faces of the double door gate apparatus **10** where the front and rear faces of the double door gate apparatus **10** are defined by the front and rear faces of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**, where such front faces are coplanar and where such rear faces are coplanar. The portion of the disk like section **118** that extends beyond the front face of the double door gate apparatus **10** is circular for about 180 degrees. The inner edge of the disk like section **118** tangentially confronts a corner vertical edge **120** of a face of the inner end of second portion **106**.

(57) Second portion **106** includes the insertable male section **110** that that is rectangular in section and that is inserted into the open female end **76** of lowermost horizontal support member **64**. On each of its front and rear faces, insertable male section **110** includes a pair of vertically extending spaced apart nubs **112** or raised sections **112** that offer a friction fit with the associated inside faces of the interior of the female open end **76** of the lowermost horizontal support member **64**. Except

for the raised sections **112**, insertable male section **110** has a width that is substantially equal to the distance between the inside front and rear faces of open female end **76** and its lowermost horizontal support member **64** and a height that is substantially equal to the distance between the inside bottom and top surfaces of the open female end **76** and its lowermost horizontal support member **64**. The top and bottom faces of insertable male section **110** are smooth and flat and planar and have no raised sections. Insertable male section **110** is hidden from view when in lowermost horizontal support member **64**.

(58) Second portion **106** includes the visible stop section **114**. Visible stop section **114** is rectangular in section and includes a width and height greater than the respective width and height of insertable male section **110** of second portion **106**. The width and height of visible stop section **114** of second portion **106** is substantially the same as the width and height of the outside faces of the lowermost horizontal support member **64**. When the insertable male section **110** of second portion **106** is inserted into the open female end **76**, the rectangular stop edge **116** stops the insertion of the second portion **106** into the lowermost horizontal support member **64** by abutting up against the inner end **76** of the lowermost horizontal support member **64**. When second portion **106** is engaged to the open female end **76** of lowermost horizontal frame support member **64**, visible stop section **114** of second portion **106** is visible.

(59) Second portion **106** includes a disk like section **122** extending from the outer end of visible stop section **114** of second portion **106**. Disk like section **122** extends from a horizontally extending lower portion of the inner end face of visible stop section **114** of second portion **106**. A bottom face of disk like section **122** is coplanar with bottom faces of visible sections **114** of each of the first and second portions **104**, **106**. An upper face of disk like section **122** confronts and abuts and is adjacent to a lower face of disk like section **118**. The circumferential portions of the disk like sections **118**, **122** that extend beyond the front face of double door gate apparatus **10** for 180 degrees are coaxial with each other and are flush with each other. Each of the disk like portions **118**, **122** are sandwiched between the inner ends of the visible sections **114** of first and second portions **104**, **106**.

(60) Disk like section **122** is spaced from the top of the visible stop section **114** of second portion **106**. Disk like section **122** includes a circular circumference that extends for about 270 degrees of a total circumference of the disk like section **122**. About one-half of the disk like section **122** extends beyond the front face of the double door gate apparatus **10** where the front face of the double door gate apparatus **10** is defined by the front faces of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**, which front faces are co-planar. The remaining one-half of the disk like section **122** is disposed between the front and rear faces of the double door gate apparatus **10** where the front and rear faces of the double door gate apparatus **10** are defined by the front and rear faces of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**, where such front faces are coplanar and where such rear faces are coplanar. The portion of the disk like section **122** that extends beyond the front face of the double door gate apparatus **10** is circular for about 180 degrees. The inner edge of the disk like section **122** tangentially confronts a corner vertical edge **124** of a face of the inner end of first portion **102**.

(61) Pivot pin **108** includes an axis that is in the plane defined by the front face of double door gate apparatus **10**, which front face is defined by the front faces of lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**. With the pivot pin **108** disposed as such, the front faces of each of the first and second base frames **16**, **22** can swing toward each other so as to confront and abut up against each other, where the front faces of each of the first and second base frames **16**, **22** are defined by respective front faces of lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**. When the first and second base frames **16**, **22** confront each other, such a position may be referred to as a storage configuration or a folded configuration and the double door gate apparatus **10** may be shipped in such a folded configuration with the first and second gates **18**, **24** engaged to their respective first and second base frames **16**, **22**. Prior to set up, the first and second base frames **16**, **22** are unfolded

and placed into a coplanar position with each other. Then the first connector **88** is affixed to the inner end portions of the lowermost horizontal support members **32, 64** such that the first and second base frames **16, 22** are rigidly and nonpivotably engaged to each other. As a whole, first portion **104**, second portion **106**, and pivot pin **108** can be referred to as a pivot junction or pivot knuckle.

(62) Each of the insertable male sections **110** of the first and second portions **104, 106** are made up of two boxes **125, 126** that share an inner wall or an end side. Each of the boxes **125, 126** includes five sides and an open bottom, where the five sides include a front side, a back side, a top side and two end sides and where the top side is opposite of the open bottom.

(63) The visible section **114** is made up of a single box having five sides and an open bottom, where the five sides include a front side, a back side, a top side and two end sides and where the top side is opposite of the open bottom. Visible section **114** shares an end wall with box **126** of insertable male section **110**, with the end wall of the visible section **114** having a greater width and height than the end wall of box **126**.

(64) Piece **34**, junction **56** and pivoting stop **58** are shown in greater detail in FIG. 5. Piece **34** includes a lower and outer portion **36** that includes a distal apertured end **128** for the pin or axle of a hand wheel **130**. The distal apertured end **128** includes an annular toothed portion **132** that engages with an annular toothed portion **134** of fencing **12**. Toothed portions **132, 134** are squeezed together by a turning of the hand wheel **130** after a position of the fencing **12** is set. Distal apertured end **128** may be configured to engage to fencing different from fencing **12** or to engage to other vertical structures.

(65) The transition from the lower and outer portion **36** to the upper and inner portion **38** occurs over the vertical support **30**.

(66) Upper and inner portion **38** extends inwardly to mount pivot post **40**. A distal end **135** of the upper and inner portion **38** includes a curved or circular surface or face that extends from a front of the upper and inner portion **38** to a rear of the upper and inner portion **38**. A raised inwardly and vertically extending nub **139** is disposed half-way from the front to the rear of the distal end **135** on such circular surface of the distal end **135** to engage an indent **150** in the pivoting stop **58** to hold the pivoting stop **58** against freely pivoting to the front or rear. Upper and inner portion **38** includes an underface or stop **136**.

(67) Junction **56** is a junction that avoids or works around a conventional right angle junction. In other words, if top horizontal support member **50** is extended hypothetically to equal the distance to which lowermost horizontal support member **32** is extended, and if tubular outer end support member **42** is extended hypothetically to equal the distance to which inner end support member **48** is extended, then such hypothetical extensions meet at a hypothetical junction directly under the underface or stop **136**. The present inventors avoid this hypothetical junction. Such hypothetical junction does not permit the raising of gate **18** on post **40**.

(68) Junction **56** takes the scenic route or an oblique route from top horizontal support member **50** to outer end support member **42**. Junction **56** permits the raising or lifting of gate **18** on post **40**. Junction **56** is an oblique junction. Junction **56** includes a cut out **137** formed by first stop or horizontal face **138** and vertical face **140**. The cut out **137** permits the raising of first gate **18** until the first stop **138** makes contact with the underface or stop **136** of piece **34**. First stop **138** is formed on a portion of junction **56** adjacent to post **40**. Post **40** extends through first stop **138**. Post **40** extends through underface or stop **136**.

(69) Junction **56** includes a second stop **140**. Second stop **140** is adjacent to top horizontal support member **50**. Second stop **140** is parallel to the upper surface of top horizontal support member **50**. Second stop **140** is located on junction **56** at a greater elevation than is first stop **138**. Second stop **140** runs parallel to first stop **138**. Second stop **140** is offset in the vertical direction from first stop **138**. Second stop **140** is a stop for the pivoting stop **58**.

(70) Junction **56** includes a receptor **142** for engaging top horizontal support member **50**. Top

horizontal support member **50** extends outwardly beyond the outermost vertical support member **54**, but does not extend to the post **40**. Top horizontal support member **50** may be friction fit into the receptor **142**.

(71) Junction **56** includes a receptor **144** for the outer end vertical support member **42**. Outer end vertical support member **42** may be friction fit into the receptor **144**.

(72) Junction **56** generally lies in a plane defined by the double door gate apparatus **10** when the first and second gates **18**, **24** are closed.

(73) As shown in FIG. 5, lift inhibitor or pivoting stop **58** is pivotably engaged to the distal end of upper and inner piece **38** of piece **34**. Pivoting stop **58** includes an underface stop **146**. Underface stop **146** is swingable forwardly and rearwardly of the first base frame **16**. Underface stop **146** can swing into and through the vertical plane defined by the first base frame **16**. Underface stop **146** can come to a rest in the vertical plane defined by the first base frame **16**. A finger handle **148** is disposed 180 degrees opposite of the underface stop **146**. Finger handle **148** can be gripped between the thumb and first finger to pivot the underface stop **146** to the desired location. When the underface stop **146** is disposed in the plane defined by the first base frame **16**, the underface stop **146** prevents the first gate **18** from being raised or lifted by making contact with the second stop **140** when an attempt is made to raise or lift the first gate **18**. Pivoting stop **58** includes a pivot pin **149** recessed in a boss **151**. Pivot pin **149** engages pivoting stop **58** to the distal end **135** of the upper and inwardly extending portion **38**.

(74) Pivoting stop **58** is shown in greater detail in FIGS. 6A, 6B, 6C, 6D, 6E and 6F. Pivoting stop **58** includes a functional undersurface and a functional upper surface. The functional undersurface includes a curved or circular region **152** that rides on the curved or circular vertical face of distal end **135**. Region **152** includes the indent **150** that receives the nub **139**. Nub **139** snaps into and out of the indent **150** as the pivoting stop **58** is pivoted to an out-of-the-way position or an out-of-the-plane position to permit the first gate **18** to be lifted or raised. The stop face **146** is another portion of the functional undersurface of pivoting stop **58**. The functional undersurface further includes a flat portion **154** that rotates on the upper surface of the upper and inwardly extending section **38**.

(75) Opposite of the flat portion **154** is boss **151** that receives pivot pin **149**. Pivot pin **149** extends through opening **156** into the distal end **135** of piece **34**. The head of the pivot pin **149** is relatively deeply received in boss **151**. Boss **151** includes a circular upper edge and the head of pivot pin **149** is below such circular upper edge. Finger handle **148** is a ridge. A like ridge structure **158** extends on the opposite side of boss **151** to an upper face **160** that opposes stop face **146**. Ridge structure **158** is L-shaped and resides in a common plane with finger handle **148**. Ridge structure **158**, like finger handle **148**, may be gripped between the thumb and first finger to pivot the pivoting stop **58**.

(76) FIG. 7 shows the latch apparatus **28**. Latch apparatus **28** includes a keeper **162** and a latch arm **164**. Latch arm **164** includes a catch end **165**.

(77) Keeper **162** includes a box like housing **166** that is engaged on and slides on the top horizontal support member **80**. An extension **168** rises from a distal end of the housing **166** and rises above a flat top of the housing **166** such that a finger or hand can push against the extension **168** and, in doing so, slide the housing **166** away from the latch arm **164**. A proximal end of the housing **166** includes a catch **167** having a frontwardly and downwardly extending surface and an undersurface. The catch end **165** of the latch arm **164** slides down the frontwardly and downwardly extending surface of the catch **167** and, in doing so, pushes the housing **166** rearwardly. Once the housing **166** is pushed sufficiently far, the catch end **165** of the latch arm **164** slides off the frontwardly and downwardly extending surface of the catch **167**, whereupon the biased housing **166** under the pressure of a coil spring quickly returns forwardly, thereby catching the catch end **165** of the latch arm **164** on the undersurface of the catch **167** such that the catch end **165** of the latch arm **164** is retained from swinging upwardly until the housing **166** is again slid rearwardly. Housing **166** is normally biased in the forwardly sliding direction toward the latch arm **164** under the pressure of an internal coil spring in the housing **166**.

(78) Latch arm **164** includes catch end **165**. Latch arm **164** further includes a pair of spaced apart side plate portions **170** engaged to each other by a top plate portion **172**. Spaced apart ear sections **174** of the side plate portions **170** are found on a distal end of the latch arm **164**. Latch arm **164** includes an open portion **176** defined by the spaced apart ear sections **174**. Top plate portion **172** also defines the open portion **176** and the proximal end of the open portion **176**. Bottom edges of ear sections **164** define an open bottom of the latch arm **164**. Latch arm **164** is pivotally engaged to the distal end of top horizontal support arm **80** adjacent to the junction between top horizontal support arm **80** and inner end vertical support arm **78** of the second gate frame **26**. A pivot pin **178** engages side plate portions **170** and the top horizontal support arm **80**. Wound about and engaging the portion of the pivot pin **178** in tubular top horizontal support arm **80** is a torsion spring, where a free end of the torsion spring presses upwardly against the underside of top plate portion **172** to normally bias the latch arm **164** in an unengaged position where the latch arm **164** extends vertically and generally in line with inner end vertical support member **78**. In an engaged position, the ear sections **174** are disposed on either side of first gate **18**, specifically on either side of the inner or distal end of the top horizontal support member **50** of first gate frame **20** and on either side of the inner end vertical support member **48** of the first gate frame **20**.

(79) To open the latch apparatus **28**, the keeper **162** is slid by hand toward the outer or proximal end of the top horizontal support member **80**. This sliding releases the catch end **165** of the latch arm **164**, which under pressure of its torsion spring pivots such that ear sections **174** swing downwardly and out of engagement with first gate **18** and such that catch end **165** swings upwardly until a stop, such as an inner protrusion on an inner face of one or more of the ear sections **174** hits the inner face of the inner end vertical support member **78**. At this point, first gate **18** can swing, provided first gate **18** has been lifted such that U-shaped member **60** has cleared the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. Subsequently, first gate **18** is swung back and lowered such that U-shaped member **60** again engages lowermost horizontal support member **32**. Then the user may push down upon top plate **172** such that catch end **165** pivots downwardly and then slides down the frontwardly and downwardly engaging surface of the catch **167** so as to push the housing **166** toward the outer or proximal end of top horizontal support member **80** until catch end **165** crosses the tip of the catch **167**, whereupon the housing **166** is pushed forwardly by its internal coil spring such that the undersurface of the catch **167** engages the catch end **165** to retain the ear sections **174** in a latched position on either side of the first gate **18**.

(80) Second connector **182** is an alternate to second connector **90**. Whereas second connector **90** provides for a folding or pivoting of first and second base frames **16**, **22**, second connector **182** is a rigid connector that does not allow for pivoting of first and second base frames **16**, **22** relative to each other. Second connector **182** supplements the first connector **88** or may be used to the exclusion of first connector **88**. In other words, 1) connector **88** or connector **182** may be used alone, or 2) connectors **88** and **182** may be used at the same time. Connector **88** engages exterior portions of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**. Connector **182** engages interior portions of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**.

(81) Connector **182** is integral and one-piece. Connector **182** is shown engaged to the double door gate apparatus **10** in FIG. **9** where connector **182** replaces connector **90** of FIG. **2**. Reference number **10'** indicates the double door gate apparatus having connector **182** and reference number **10** indicates the double door gate apparatus having connector **90**.

(82) Connector **182** includes the insertable male section **110** that that is rectangular in section and that is inserted into the open female end **46** of lowermost horizontal support member **32**. On each of its front and rear faces, insertable male section **110** includes the pair of vertically extending spaced apart nubs **112** or raised sections **112** that offer a friction fit with the associated inside faces of the interior of the female open end **46** of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. Except for the raised sections **112**, insertable male section **110** has a width that is substantially equal to the distance between the inside front and rear faces of open female end **46** and its lowermost horizontal

support member **32** and a height that is substantially equal to the distance between the inside bottom and top surfaces of the open female end **46** and its lowermost horizontal support member **32**. The top and bottom faces of insertable male section **110** are smooth and flat and planar and have no raised sections. Insertable male section **110** is hidden from view when in lowermost horizontal support member **32**.

(83) Connector **182** includes a visible stop section **184**. Visible stop section **184** is rectangular in section and includes a width and height greater than the respective width and height of insertable male section **110**. The width and height of visible stop section **114** is substantially the same as the width and height of the outer surfaces of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. When the insertable male section **110** of connector **182** is inserted into the open female end **46**, the rectangular stop edge **116** stops the insertion of the second connector **182** into the lowermost horizontal support member **32** by abutting up against the inner end **46** of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. When connector **182** is engaged to the open female end **46** of lowermost horizontal frame support member **32**, visible stop section **184** of first portion **104** is visible.

(84) Connector **182** includes a second insertable male section **110** that is rectangular in section and that is inserted into the open female end **76** of lowermost horizontal support member **64**. On each of its front and rear faces, this second insertable male section **110** includes a pair of vertically extending spaced apart nubs **112** or raised sections **112** that offer a friction fit with the associated inside faces of the interior of the female open end **76** of the lowermost horizontal support member **64**. Except for the raised sections **112**, this second insertable male section **110** has a width that is substantially equal to the distance between the inside front and rear faces of open female end **76** and its lowermost horizontal support member **64** and a height that is substantially equal to the distance between the inside bottom and top surfaces of the open female end **76** and its lowermost horizontal support member **64**. The top and bottom faces of this second insertable male section **110** are smooth and flat and planar and have no raised sections. This second insertable male section **110** is hidden from view when in lowermost horizontal support member **64**.

(85) Second connector **182** includes first and second insertable male sections **110** on, respectively, first and second ends. First and second insertable male sections **110** are one-piece and integral with visible stop section **184**.

(86) Visible stop section **184** is rectangular in section and includes a width and height greater than the respective width and height of the second insertable male section **110**. The width and height of visible stop section **184** is substantially the same as the width and height of the outside faces of the lowermost horizontal support member **64**. When the second insertable male section **110** of second connector **182** is inserted into the open female end **76**, the second rectangular stop edge **116** stops the insertion of the second connector **182** into the lowermost horizontal support member **64** by abutting up against the inner end **76** of the lowermost horizontal support member **64**. When the second connector **182** is engaged to the open female end **76** of lowermost horizontal frame support member **64**, visible stop section **184** of the second connector **182** is visible.

(87) Each of the first and second insertable male sections **110** of the second connector **182** are made up of two boxes **125**, **126** that share an inner wall or an end side. Each of the boxes **125**, **126** includes five sides and an open bottom, where the five sides include a front side, a back side, a top side and two end sides and where the top side is opposite of the open bottom.

(88) The visible stop section **184** is made up of four box like structures **186** having five sides and an open bottom, where the five sides include a front side, a back side, a top side and two end sides and where the top side is opposite of the open bottom. Visible section **185** shares an end wall with box **126** of each of the first and second insertable male sections **110**, with such end wall of the visible section **184** having a greater width and height than the end wall of box **126**.

(89) Prior to operation, an unassembled double door gate apparatus **10** or **10'** may be shipped. In an unassembled form, each of the following parts may not be connected to any of the other following parts: 1) the first base frame **16**, 2) the second base frame **22**, 3) the first gate **18**, 4) the second gate

24, 5) the first connector **88**, 6) the second connector **90**, and 7) the second connector **182**. The end user may have the choice of using either of the second connectors **90**, **182**. At this point, it should be noted that the length of the first gate **16** is generally the same as the length of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**, which defines the length of the first base frame **16**. Likewise, the length of the second gate **24** is generally the same as the length of the lowermost horizontal support member **64**, which defines the length of the second base frame **22**. Accordingly, applicant takes advantage of the length of the longest piece to include other pieces of the same length because the shipping carton necessarily is about the length of the longest piece. Since applicant takes advantage of such, a double door gate apparatus **10** or **10'** of a greater overall length may be formed by the end user without any increase in the length of the shipping carton. That applicant takes advantage of such can be seen in FIG. 2, where it is shown that the inner end of the first gate **18** extends beyond the inner end of the lowermost horizontal support member **32** and where it is shown that the inner end of the second gate **24** extends beyond the inner end of the lowermost horizontal support member **64**. When assembled, first gate **18** is offset from its first base frame **16**. When assemble, second gate **24** is offset from its second base frame **22**. Applicant then covers the distance between the inner ends **46** and **76** of the respective lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64** by engaging the first and second connectors **88** and **90** on the one hand or engaging the first and second connectors **88** and **182** on the other hand. If desired, first and second connectors **88**, **182** may be one-piece with each other or engaged to each other either before or after assembly.

(90) In operation, after assembly of the double door gate apparatus **10** or **10'** and after engaging one or more of the connectors **88**, **90**, **182**, the double door gate apparatus **10** or **10'** takes the form shown in FIG. 2 or FIG. 9. If only connector **90** is engaged the double door apparatus **10** may be folded for storage such that first and second gates **18**, **24** confront each other face to face. If at least one of the connectors **88**, **182** is engaged, the first and second base frames **16**, **22** are rigid and one-piece. If connectors **88** and **90** are engaged, the first and second base frames **16**, **22** are rigid and one-piece. If connectors **88** and **182** are engaged, the first and second base frames **16**, **22** are rigid and one-piece. Each of the connectors **88**, **90** and **182** is removable from the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64** after being engaged thereto. Connector **88** engages exterior portions of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**. Connectors **90** and **182** engage interior portions of the lowermost horizontal support members **32**, **64**.

(91) To open the second gate **24** of the double door gate apparatus **10** or **10'** from the closed configuration shown in FIG. 2 or FIG. 9, the keeper **162** is slid away from the latch arm **164** to release the spring loaded latch arm **164**, which pivots to a vertical position so as to no longer engage the first and second gates **18**, **24** to each other. Then second gate **24** may be swung open in the direction permitted by stop **86**. To close the second gate **24**, the second gate **24** is swung back to be co-planar with the second base frame **22**. Then catch end **165** is lowered to snappingly engage the catch **167** of the keeper **162**.

(92) To open the first gate **18** of the double door gate apparatus **10** or **10'** from the closed configuration shown in FIG. 2 or FIG. 9, the pivoting stop **58** is pivoted to an out-of-the-way position. Then the first gate **18** is lifted such that the bottom edges of the U-shaped stop **60** attain a higher elevation than the upper surface of lowermost horizontal support member **32**. This lifting raises the inner end of first gate **18** between the ear sections **174** of the latch arm **164**. Then the keeper **162** is slid away from the latch arm **164** to release the spring loaded latch arm **164**, which pivots to a vertical position so as to no longer engage the first gate **18**. Then the first gate **18** may be swung in either direction away from the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. To close the first gate **18**, the first gate **18** is raised so that the bottom edges of U-shaped stop **60** clear the upper surface of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. Then the first gate **18** is swung to be co-planar with the first base frame **16**. Then the first gate **18** is lowered such that the U-shaped stop **60** is disposed on each of the sides of the lowermost horizontal support member **32**. Then the catch end **165** is lowered to engage the catch **167** of the keeper **162** such that ear sections **174** engage the

inner end of first gate **18**. Then the pivoting stop **58** is pivoted to engage the upper surface of junction **56**.

(93) If desired, both of gates **18** and **24** may be open at the same time.

(94) Thus since the invention disclosed herein may be embodied in other specific forms without departing from the spirit or general characteristics thereof, some of which forms have been indicated, the embodiments described herein are to be considered in all respects illustrative and not restrictive. The scope of the invention is to be indicated by the appended claims, rather than by the foregoing description, and all changes which come within the meaning and range of equivalents of the claims are intended to be embraced therein.

Claims

1. A double door gate apparatus comprising: a) a first base frame, the first base frame including a first outer end frame member that extends vertically and a first lowermost frame member that extends horizontally, the first lowermost frame member having a first inner end, the first inner end having a top face, front face, and rear face; b) a first gate pivotally engaged to the first base frame; c) a second base frame, the second base frame including a second outer end frame member that extends vertically and a second lowermost frame member that extends horizontally, the second lowermost frame member having a second inner end, the second inner end having a top face, front face and rear face; d) a second gate pivotally engaged to the second base frame; e) the first gate having an uppermost frame member; f) the second gate having an uppermost frame member; g) a latch apparatus engaging the uppermost frame member of the first gate and further engaging the uppermost frame member of the second gate; h) a connector engaging the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member to the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member, the connector being disengagable from each of the first inner end of the first lowermost frame member and the second inner end of the second lowermost frame member without destroying an integrity of any of the first and second lowermost frame members; and i) a space between the first and second gates defining a vertical axis, the vertical axis extending through the connector; j) a first portion of the connector being adjacent to a portion of the first gate when the first gate is closed; k) a second portion of the connector being adjacent to a portion of the second gate when the second gate is closed.
 2. The double door gate apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first gate has a first width, wherein the second gate has a second width, and wherein the first and second widths are the same.
 3. The double door gate apparatus of claim 2, wherein the first gate includes no more and no less than a given number of upright support members and wherein the second gate includes no more and no less than said given number of upright support members.
 4. The double door gate apparatus of claim 1, wherein one gate is liftable and one gate is non-liftable at all times, wherein the gate that is liftable includes a top surface spaced from a first portion of one of the base frames such that said top surface is liftable up to be adjacent to said first portion.
 5. The double door gate apparatus of claim 1, wherein one gate is liftable and one gate is non-liftable at all times, wherein the gate that is non-liftable includes a top surface that abuts at all times a second portion of one of the base frames such that said gate is not liftable at all times.
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